



Tough outing: This New Zealand series marked Ravichandran Ashwin's second-poorest Test outing at home, with a bowling average of 41.22 runs per wicket. EMMANUAL YOGINI

defend against the tweekers.

This tendency was on display against the Kiwis, with the Indians scoring at almost four runs an over (3.97) throughout the series and taking it a notch higher by going at 4.16 per over against the spinners. In contrast, New Zealand struck at a significantly more sedate 3.66 runs an over against the spinners.

India's aggression didn't yield dividends, however, as Mitchell Santner and Ajaz Patel picked up 28 wickets between them, and four Kiwi spinners accounted for 37 Indian scalps to precipitate the host's surrender.

India skipper Rohit, in admitting his own shortcomings in the series, also summed up the team's travails. "I need to spend more time to defend balls, which I haven't done in this series, and I accept that I haven't batted well in this series."

Throughout the series, it seemed that most Indian batters were in a tearing hurry to score runs, perhaps trying hard to follow the 'Bazball' model. And that plan clearly did not work in the home team's favour.

Rohit faced a total of 133 balls across six innings, tallying a mere 91 runs, while middle-order mainstay Virat Kohli eked out 93 runs in six innings, facing 173 deliveries.

Yashasvi Jaiswal (308 balls) was the only Indian batter who faced in excess of 300 balls, while Rishabh Pant (261 runs) was the lone Indian

ASHWIN AND JADEJA'S STRUGGLE WITH THE BALL WAS EXACERBATED BY CAPTAIN ROHIT'S OVERLY DEFENSIVE FIELD PLACEMENTS